LAUREN CHAPLINSKI

Senior Data Engineer | Contract & Consulting | Cloud Data Pipelines · Migrations · Regulated Data

Chicago, Illinois · hi@laurenchaplinski.com · 773-988-3578 · linkedin.com/in/lauren-chaplinski · laurenchaplinski.com · github.com/aladyinsane

SUMMARY

Senior data engineer with 8 years building production data systems for organizations where data is high-stakes and heavily regulated - federal, state, and international government agencies and national healthcare payers - on a foundation of 12+ years working with healthcare administrative claims and clinical risk data. Builds pipelines designed to hold up under CMS and regulatory scrutiny; that work has directly informed rate-setting and payment-policy decisions covering hundreds of millions of dollars in Medicaid payments. Deep experience designing data lakes and automated pipelines, integrating cloud APIs with legacy software, and modeling large claims and payment datasets. Comfortable owning a technical workstream end to end: scoping, building, testing, documenting, and training the team that inherits it.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python (production systems, automated testing), SQL, PySpark, R, SAS, JavaScript/Node.js, VBA

Cloud & Data Platforms: Azure Data Factory, Azure Synapse, Azure SQL, Azure Data Lake, Databricks, Palantir Foundry, SQL Server / SSIS, Docker, Tailscale, n8n, data lake architecture

Analytics & BI: Power BI (enterprise dashboards), Tableau, statistical & predictive modeling, ML model interpretation, simulation modeling

Practices: Pipeline automation and orchestration, API integration, data quality frameworks, metadata management, GitHub, Jira, DevOps, technical documentation, agentic AI development

Domain Data: Healthcare administrative claims (Medicaid, Medicare, commercial), CMS public datasets (HCRIS, T-MSIS, NPPES), CDC PLACES, HRSA workforce data, US Census data, Solventum grouping input/output/configuration (APR-DRGs, MS-DRGs, EAPGs, APCs), HIPAA environments

SELECTED PROJECTS

Payment Simulation & Policy Modeling for State Medicaid Agencies

SAS · SQL · Excel · APR-DRG · EAPG · claim-level payment modeling

- Built a repeatable SAS rate-setting pipeline modeling four inpatient hospital rate simulations across roughly 14,400 claims for a Medicaid agency transitioning APR-DRG grouper versions; findings informed rate implementation covering roughly $148M in inpatient payments while raising rural obstetric providers to 100% of estimated cost.
- Built provider-level payment modeling and Upper Payment Limit (UPL) demonstrations for state supplemental payment programs supporting more than $95M in annual payments, engineered to withstand CMS review.
- Modeled the fiscal impact of a proposed policy limiting Medicaid Medicare-crossover payments to the lesser of the Medicaid fee schedule amount or beneficiary cost-sharing liability, quantifying an estimated potential $46M in annual savings for the state.
- Estimated roughly $3.1M in combined potential annual reimbursement if four rural hospitals resumed obstetric services, giving agency leadership a quantified financial incentive for the hospitals to restore rural maternity care.

Cloud API Integration for Legacy Rate-Setting Systems

Python · REST APIs · automated testing

- Designed and built production-grade Python integrations connecting external cloud APIs to legacy internal software supporting multi-million-dollar, multiyear actuarial and rate-setting projects; work critical to business continuity after the vendor discontinued its on-premises product.
- Built automated test coverage, wrote configuration and operations documentation, and trained colleagues to run and maintain the system independently.

Price Transparency Data Lake

Azure · Python · 80+ external data sources

- Architected a data lake and automated pipelines to discover, acquire, and ingest machine-readable files from 80+ payer organizations under the federal Transparency in Coverage Act - large-scale, messy, externally-published data at volume.

- Automated data quality metric reporting across all sources, turning an unmanageable manual review problem into a monitored pipeline.

Federal Analytics Product in Palantir Foundry

Palantir · Python · R · Power BI · technical lead

- Led a technical team delivering demographic and geographic analyses of social drivers of health for a large US federal agency, combining public and client data.
- Built the full pipeline, analyses, and visualizations inside Palantir Foundry so the product deployed directly into the agency's own data ecosystem rather than as a throwaway deliverable.

Rural Provider Gap Analysis & Analytics Platform

SAS · Python · Power BI · NPPES · CDC PLACES · HRSA

- Built a multi-source analytics platform unifying Medicaid, Medicare, and commercial claims with NPPES provider, CDC PLACES, and HRSA workforce and census data, applying diagnosis groups/service category crosswalks to evaluate rural healthcare access and specialty shortages statewide.

International Supply Chain Dashboards

SQL · Power BI

- Developed healthcare supply chain monitoring dashboards for an East African national government: reporting compliance, supplier performance, stock availability, and recall tracking; SQL for cleaning and standardization, Power BI for delivery.

Independent / Side Projects

- Synthetic data generator: profiles statistical properties of source datasets and generates privacy-safe synthetic CSVs preserving cross-column correlation via Gaussian copula; built for regulated environments where production data can't be used in testing.
- Self-hosted multiplayer game (2084): a text-based MUD built on the Evennia framework (Python), with game design, backend, deployment, and networking owned end to end.
- Self-hosted Docker event-driven home automation stack (MQTT, Home Assistant, Tailscale).
- Self-hosted AI-native Markdown note-taking system (SilverBullet, n8n, Tailscale, Claude Code); six automated n8n workflows, including a read-only-scoped agent for weekly review.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Guidehouse — Managing Consultant, Data Science (State Health and Human Services)

Oct 2018 – Present · Chicago, IL

- Technical delivery lead across data engineering, data product development, and payment analytics for national healthcare organizations and US federal, state, and international government clients; detailed in Selected Projects above.
- Additional project work includes fee schedule-based outpatient payment system redesign and provider-level revenue-neutrality modeling for a large commercial payer; monthly behavioral health utilization reporting with full technical specification documentation for a state agency; various healthcare value transformation and payment analytics consulting projects.

Presence Health — Insurance & Claims Management

Mar 2013 – Oct 2018 · Chicago, IL

- Analyzed claims data and built reports and visualizations for stakeholders across a large Illinois non-profit health system's self-insurance program; administered claims management databases, including data dictionary maintenance and user report development.
- Automated administrative and risk-management reporting processes; origin of both the programming path and deep familiarity with healthcare operational, financial, and liability data.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S. Business Data Analytics — Loyola University Chicago, 2018 (3.97 GPA; Beta Gamma Sigma; Dean's Honors)

B.A. — Columbia College Chicago, 2009

Certifications: SAS Programming 1: Essentials (SAS)